> purposes. In fact, bad Indo-American relations might give China an eventual advantage over the United States.… It would not do to leave the Soviet Union a large field of uncontested influence.… In the context of a future US-USSR-China-Japan power quadrangle, it would not be wise to jettison friendship with the next largest power in Asia.[15]

Intelligence analysis suggested the prospects for improvement were "not bright" because the need was a bit lopsided—the "fact is that USA is much more important to India than vice-versa." Thus analysts recommended that "the best that one can suggest is an assiduous effort to cool down the political tempers on both sides and to seek and develop cooperation in areas where we share common interests."[16]

Publicly and privately, Indian policymakers signaled they wanted better relations. Following a public overture by the foreign minister, the *New York Times* urged a "warm response" to the "Indian love call."[17] Rogers pointed out to Nixon that Indian policymakers had toned down their criticisms of the US.[18] In a "cordial" conversation with Deputy Secretary of State Kenneth Rush, Gandhi herself indicated that she wanted to improve relations.[19]

Nixon had been hesitant to do very much for India just before the 1972 election, thinking it would be seen as an admission that he had erred during the 1971 crisis. Kissinger told Jha that after the elections, the president would be "ready and anxious to normalize and improve relations with India." Jha interpreted this as a genuine overture because the president wanted to "go down in history as the man who gave a generation of peace." With working relationships in Asia with China, Japan, and the Soviet Union, one of the few countries that Nixon needed to make up with was India. Kissinger agreed with Indian officials that improved relations were important for "peace and stability in Asia."[20]

The Nixon administration came to believe that, given increasing instability in other parts of the world, the US could reduce the likelihood that the subcontinent would prove bothersome with a rapprochement with India. This would allow the US to limit the resources and attention it would need to dedicate to the area. Thus, over the rest of the Nixon administration and then the Gerald Ford administration, the two countries worked to